The major: It is permissible and meritorious to kill a tyrant.

The minor: The duke of Orleans was a tyrant.

The conclusion: Therefore the duke of Burgundy did well to kill him.[8]

Aristotle's rules of thought had found yet another use.

Charles VI, anxious to keep the peace in Paris, granted his cousin a free pardon the very next day. The indignant supporters of the Duke of Orleans, led by his wife, at once formed an anti-Burgundy faction, uniting behind his son and heir: fourteen-year-old Charles, the new Duke of Orleans. The houses of Orleans and Burgundy appeared poised to throw the country into civil war.[9]

In 1410, young Charles married the daughter of the Count of Armagnac, and the Count became the leader of the anti-Burgundy party. From this point on, the partisans of the House of Orleans were known as the Armagnacs; they were from the west and the south and numbered among themselves the Dukes of Berry and Bourbon, and the Constable of France. The Burgundy party was from the north and the east.

Equally balanced in power, both parties hoped for the support of the new English king to break the stalemate.

HENRY V was crowned at Westminster on April 9, 1413, in the middle of a freak snowstorm that buried animals and houses and killed scores of men caught out unawares. Some Londoners muttered that the blizzard was a sign: the new king would be "a man of cold deeds, and severe."[10]

He was twenty-seven years old, wound-scarred and experienced from his years fighting against the Mortimers and the Welsh. Almost at once, two sets of envoys arrived at the English court, one from the Armagnac party (which now counted Charles VI himself among its adherents) and one from the Duke of Burgundy, both asking to be "strengthened" in their struggle against the other party.[11]

Henry V was willing to help with the struggle. He offered to drive a bargain with the Armagnac party; he would defeat the Duke of Burgundy, in exchange for the crown of France, marriage with the king's daughter Catherine, and a dowry of two million crowns.*

This was not so much an offer as an incitement to war. "And so," says the *Chronica Maiora* of Thomas Walsingham, "hopes of peace were completely put to sleep." The family struggle of the Valois had opened the door to English invasion.[12]

By the summer of 1415, Henry V had organized the ships, men, war machines, armaments and provisions needed to renew the war with France.